



Pathological Whiteness: Diagnosing the Hidden Wound

Reflect

- In your own terms, describe what you think Chanequa means when she describes whiteness as a pathology. What questions do you have about this idea?
- One of Chanequa's central claims is that it is whiteness, not blackness, that is at the heart of the problem of racism. How does this claim change the way you think about racism and its solutions?
- Chanequa outlines three symptoms of "pathological whiteness": conformity, unwavering trust in authority, and selective sight. Which one of these symptoms is the most evident to you in our society? Which is the least evident?

Respond

- By "selective sight," Chanequa refers to the way which we willingly or sub-consciously fail to see something that is in plain view. What experiences or practices would help to correct selective sight, especially as it relates to racial injustice?
- What are some practical ways that you can resist the symptoms of whiteness that Chanequa names? What role does your faith play in this process?